

Ali Hejazizo

AI Lead Engineer

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Highlights

- **AI Leadership:** Founded and led the AI team at Vendoroo, building agentic solutions that automate real estate property maintenance workflows end-to-end.
- **Entrepreneurial Impact:** Built Pytopia (20,000+ active learners) and ApplyLink (7,000+ users) from concept to market.
- **LLM Expertise:** Implemented production AI with AutoGen, LlamaIndex, and fine-tuning pipelines (LoRA, RLHF/GRPO).
- **Technical Architecture:** Designed robust backend systems with FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Celery.
- **Business Results:** Delivered 40% increase in user engagement at Dippy AI through fine-tuned character-based LLMs.

Experience

Oct 2024 – **Founding AI Lead, Vendoroo**, Remote

Present Lead a team of AI engineers developing agentic AI solutions that revolutionise communication workflows in real estate property maintenance — essentially "*Cursor for property maintenance*".

- Architect and lead the agentic AI framework, integrating AutoGen, LlamaIndex, and custom LLM implementations into production maintenance workflows.
- Build intelligent automation that reduces manual processing for property managers by co-ordinating autonomously between tenants, property managers, and service providers.
- Own the full technical strategy for the AI team, driving products from conception to deployment with high autonomy.

Aug 2024 – Dec 2024 **Senior AI Engineer, Dippy.ai**, Remote

AI engineer specialising in LLMs and conversational AI for a character-based social platform.

- Fine-tuned LLMs using LoRA and GRPO (Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback), achieving a **40 %** increase in user engagement.
- Conducted comprehensive model evaluations and A/B testing via Amplitude.
- Implemented content safety systems for NSFW detection and underage-user protection.

May 2024 – Aug 2024 **Founder in Residence, Antler**, Toronto, Canada

Selected for Antler's Cohort 6 — a prestigious 4-month startup development programme.

- Received coaching from successful entrepreneurs and industry experts.
- Developed and validated business concepts through rigorous market-fit analysis.
- Built a network with fellow founders, investors, and startup ecosystem leaders.
- Acquired pitching skills and fundraising approaches to accelerate concept-to-business-model.

May 2021 – **Founder, Pytopia**, Remote

Present Founded and grew a data science education platform and community bridging education and career success in tech.

- Developed and launched courses covering machine learning, Python, deep learning, statistics, data processing, visualisation, Linux, Django, and Docker.
- Implemented a mentorship programme providing personalised career guidance to students.
- Grew the platform to **20,000+ active learners** through online and in-person events.

- 2021 – 2024 **Senior Machine Learning Engineer**, *Affinity.co*, Remote
- Led a team of 3 engineers building ML systems for a relationship-intelligence CRM platform.
- Built a two-stage structured information extraction system using LLMs, improving accuracy from **54 % to 88 %** (Q&A stage + advanced LLM stage).
 - Created a connection-suggestion feature for investors by identifying overlapping work experiences across millions of professional profiles.
 - Applied NLP to normalise job titles, locations, and industry tags across the platform.
 - Implemented data deduplication using blocking and matching algorithms, significantly reducing redundancy in company and people records.
 - Designed and deployed gender and ethnicity detection models from names and profile images.
- 2018 – 2021 **Machine Learning Engineer**, *AltaML*, Edmonton, Canada
- 3+ years designing and deploying machine learning algorithms across client projects.
- Developed and deployed NLP and Computer Vision models for diverse industry applications.
 - Built and shipped customer-service chatbots to production.
 - Collaborated with cross-functional teams to translate business objectives into technical ML solutions.

Skills

- Languages Python, SQL
- AI / ML LLMs, AutoGen, LlamaIndex, LangChain, Fine-tuning (LoRA, RLHF/GRPO), NLP, Computer Vision
- Frameworks FastAPI, Django, Celery
- Databases PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB
- Infra Docker, Git, Linux

Education

- 2016 – 2020 **M.Sc. Computer Science**, *University of Alberta*, Edmonton, Canada, GPA: 3.9/4
- Thesis: *Combining Variational Sampling and Metropolis-Hastings Sampling for Paraphrase Generation*.
- Supervisor: Denilson Barbosa.

Honours & Awards

- Ranked **1st** in Electrical Engineering (Power Group) among more than 30 students.
- Granted admission by the Talented Student Office of Amirkabir University of Technology for graduate study.